

Tables

Learning Objectives

- Create HTML tables using table, tr, th, and td elements
- Use colspan and rowspan to merge cells in complex tables
- Apply semantic table structure with thead, tbody, and tfoot

Engage (5-7 minutes)

A spreadsheet organizes data in rows and columns. HTML tables do the same on web pages—showing timetables, price lists, and comparison charts. But unlike spreadsheets, HTML tables require careful structure for accessibility.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Create a class timetable using an HTML table with days as rows and periods as columns. Then create a product comparison table using colspan to merge headers across multiple columns. Add thead, tbody, and tfoot sections for proper structure.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

The table element contains tr (table row) elements. Th defines header cells (bold, centered by default); td defines data cells. Colspan merges cells horizontally across columns; rowspan merges vertically across rows. Thead groups header rows, tbody groups body rows, and tfoot groups footer rows—these improve accessibility and enable styling.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Design a student report card table with student information in the header, subject-wise marks in the body, and totals in the footer. Use colspan to span the student name across all columns and rowspan to group subjects under categories.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Submit a table with at least 5 rows and 4 columns, one merged cell using colspan, and proper thead/tbody/tfoot structure. Explain why using tables for layout (not data) is considered bad practice in modern web development.